THE SANDMAN: PRELUDES & NOCTURNES

Details **Originally published** The Sandman #1-8 (1989) **Publisher** Vertigo **Writer** Neil Gaiman **Artist** Various
Collected in The Sandman: Preludes & Nocturnes **Available digitally** Comixology

It's truly a testament to just how good *The Sandman* is that it remains the pinnacle of Neil Gaiman's staggeringly successful career. Taking a lesser-known DC character and creating his own universe, Gaiman was a crucial element of the rise of Vertigo and cerebral mainstream comics.

The Sandman starts, slightly awkwardly, as a horror comic, as Dream of the Endless breaks free of his prison and begins righting the wrongs that occurred in his absence. Gaiman soon drifts away from the nightmarish potential of this premise and explores the incredible possibilities that the god of the unconscious presents him with. Gaiman is helped in his task by a succession of brilliant artists, but special mention must go to long-time collaborator Dave McKean, whose covers perfectly capture the dark majesty and wonder of the central character.

From kings and madmen to Shakespeare and Lucifer, from Hell to New York to the Heart of the Dreaming, Dream's journey is gripping, moving and simply stunning in its scope. It truly does feel endless.





